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Léa

October 1944

Tonight, Josef would journey to Dippoldiswalde to purchase medical supplies, returning in the morning. Lagerführer Klein had allowed Léa and Rose to stay together in the sick bay to care for the patients while he was away.

“Will you be all right for a night?” Josef asked.

“I’ll be fine,” said Léa.

“Is Rose on her way?”

She nodded. “She’s coming back after delivering the report to Reinhardt.”

“We’re not expecting any more convoys this week, so it should be quiet.” He bent down to kiss her. “Maybe we can figure out a way for you to get permission to spend the night in the sick bay while I’m here.”

She laughed. “I would love that, but I don’t think Lagerführer Klein would approve.”

It was true that they had so little time together during the day, stealing moments to be alone, closing the door to his office and holding one another or kissing until a knock drew Josef away. As the sole doctor for all the foreign workers, he faced constant demands on his time.

A honk outside. The car was here, a black sedan parked in the dimly lit street, its headlights casting long shadows. Josef turned to Léa. “I’ll be back before you know it,” he said, trying to reassure her.

“Have a safe trip.” Léa saw him to the door. *One day,* she thought, *after the war is over, we’ll have all the time in the world to be together.*

She had a long list of things to do. First, she would change the bandage